

IT IS TIME TO BE PREPARED

INTRO: ([verywellhealth.com](https://www.verywellhealth.com))

What is a pandemic? When a contagious disease is present over a large portion of the earth – At least two or more continents. This constitutes a pandemic. What happens during a pandemic?

- Supply chains slow down... (Toilet paper – The roll is being called up yonder)
- Economics weaken... (Stock market plunges – Layoffs – Business closings)
- Schools and businesses close... (Parents become teachers and school administrators – What I never liked about school was the principle of the thing)
- Travel restrictions become necessary... (Our world gets exponentially smaller)
- Misinformation creates confusion and panic... (In times like these be VERY careful who you listen to – Walk Through The Word)

With the onset of a pandemic people understandably become anxious and afraid. Deuteronomy 3:18 ***“He will never leave you or forsake you. Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged.”*** Romans 8:28 ***“And we know that in all things God works for the good of those who love Him, who have been called according to His purpose.”*** Isaiah 43:1 ***“Don’t fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by name; you are mine.”***

The phrase ***“Fear not”*** is used at least 80 times in the Bible, most likely because the Lord knows the enemy uses fear to:

- Decrease hope...
- Limit our faith...
- Diminish our expectation for victory...

What do we do to prepare for the onslaught of fear? 1 John 4:18 ***“Perfect love casts our ALL fear.”***

- God is love, perfect love...

- The closer we come to Him the less power fear has to operate in our lives...
- Abiding in His love shelters us from fear...
Psalm 91 ***“He who dwells in the secret place of the Most High shall abide under the shadow of the Almighty.”***

Psalm 18:2 ***“The Lord is my rock, my fortress and deliverer.”***

Even though we battle anxiety there are actions that we must take to be prepared. Just like one would prepare for a hurricane or ice storm, we can prepare for a pandemic as well.

I want to bring a few things to our attention that will prepare us for what we are facing now, and could face in the future:

KEEP CALM

A crisis causes us to choose one of two emotional reactions:

- Flight...

- Fight...

Calm down – Cheer up scriptures:

Calm down... John 14:27 (AMP) *“Peace I leave with you; My [perfect] peace I give to you; not as the world gives do I give to you. Do not let your heart be troubled, nor let it be afraid. [Let My perfect peace calm you in every circumstance and give you courage and strength for every challenge.]”*

Cheer up... John 16:33 (AMP) *“I have told you these things, so that in Me you may have [perfect] peace. In the world you have tribulation and distress and suffering, but be courageous [be confident, be undaunted, be filled with joy]; I have overcome the world.” [My conquest is accomplished, My victory abiding.]”*

STAY INFORMED WITH RELIABLE FACT-BASED SOURCES

If we sit around listening to cable news all day we will be ready to slit our wrists with a dull

butter knife. Turn the TV off and turn the Word of God on.

- Read the Bible...
- Listen to a podcast...
- Turn on some worship...
- Reach out, to help someone...

Is the situation we are in, bad? Yes! We have probably never seen anything worse in our lifetimes. The fact is, God is going to see us through.

STOCK UP ON ESSENTIALS

The store shelves are empty because of panic. When this is over Charmin toilet paper company and Campbell's soup company won't be able to sell any product for two years, because people have stockpiles in their homes.

Just as the reality of a fearful situation has driven us to stock up on certain essentials, where we are prophetically should drive us to take stock spiritually. Matthew 24:1-14 (NKJV)

“Then Jesus went out and departed from the temple, and His disciples came up to show Him the buildings of the temple. ² And Jesus said to them, “Do you not see all these things? Assuredly, I say to you, not one stone shall be left here upon another, that shall not be thrown down.” (This was a prediction of His death and resurrection) *³ Now as He sat on the Mount of Olives, the disciples came to Him privately, saying, “Tell us, when will these things be? And what will be the sign of Your coming, and of the end of the age?” ⁴ And Jesus answered and said to them: “Take heed that no one deceives you. ⁵ For many will come in My name, saying, ‘I am the Christ,’ and will deceive many. (We have certainly seen this over and over) ⁶ And you will hear of wars and rumors of wars. (This has and is occurring) See that you are not troubled; for all these things must come to pass, but the end is not yet. ⁷ For nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom. (This has and is occurring) And there will be famines,*

¹ pestilences, and earthquakes in various places. (We are on the leading edge of this – We will see more of these things as we move forward) *⁸ All these are the beginning of sorrows.* *⁹ “Then they will deliver you up to tribulation and kill you, and you will be hated by all nations for My name’s sake.* (If we can’t keep our faith up during a pandemic, what are we going to do when persecution comes? It is coming – Prepare your hearts *“If in the land of peace the footmen have worn you down, how do you plan to contend with the horses that are coming?”)* *¹⁰ And then many will be offended, will betray one another, and will hate one another.* (This is currently occurring – Christians can’t get along with each other – They have taken their infighting onto social media – Sham on the church) *¹¹ Then many false prophets will rise up and deceive many.* (This is occurring as I speak) *¹² And because lawlessness will abound, the love of many will grow cold.* (The spirit of lawlessness is the spirit of antichrist – This is everywhere you look in

our culture) ¹³ ***But he who endures to the end shall be saved.*** (I'm in this for the long haul – I'm in it, to win it) ¹⁴ ***And this gospel of the kingdom will be preached in all the world as a witness to all the nations, and then the end will come.***”

Get ready, get ready, get ready – Our Lord is coming back!

WASH REGULARLY

Have you ever seen more people scrubbing their hands? Carrying around bottles of hand sanitizer? John 15:1-4 (NKJV) ***“I am the true vine, and My Father is the vinedresser. ² Every branch in Me that does not bear fruit He takes away; and every branch that bears fruit He prunes, that it may bear more fruit. ³ You are already clean because of the word which I have spoken to you. ⁴ Abide in Me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself, unless it abides in the vine, neither can you, unless you abide in Me.”***

Ephesians 5:25-27 (NKJV) *“Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ also loved the church and gave Himself for her, ²⁶ that He might sanctify and cleanse her with the washing of water by the word, ²⁷ that He might present her to Himself a glorious church, not having spot or wrinkle or any such thing, but that she should be holy and without blemish.”*

WEAR GLOVES AND PROTECTIVE MASKS

Everywhere you look people have on gloves and protective masks. Did you know a mask doesn't do much to protect you from what is in the air, it protects the environment around you from what you have! This is why doctors wear masks in surgery!

I am not discouraging us from taking whatever measures we can to practice good safety measures but the truth is, we are in a fallen

world and we are therefore susceptible to certain things.

On a more spiritual level, we have been called into this good fight of the faith and will find ourselves exposed to things that we didn't expect. For that reason, God made His armor available to us. Ephesians 6:10-13 (NKJV)

“Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord and in the power of His might. ¹¹ Put on the whole armor of God, that you may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil. ¹² For we do not wrestle against flesh and blood, but against principalities, against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this age, against spiritual hosts of wickedness in the heavenly places. ¹³ Therefore take up the whole armor of God, that you may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand.”

- Truth around your waist... (Reproductive area of the body...)

- Breastplate of righteousness... (The state of doing the right thing)
- Feet covered with the preparation of the gospel of peace... (The Word makes the journey easier)
- The shield of faith – So we can quench ALL the fiery darts of the devil...
- Helmet of salvation... (I'm saved, and I know that I am)
- Sword of the Spirit – The Word of God... (Use His Word as an offensive and defensive weapon)
- Prayer... (Praying always – Prayer grants access to Heaven – Use it – Use it often)

MAKE A PLAN

What will you do when:

- Family is trapped in the house? (Get reacquainted – There will be a bumper crop of December babies this year)
- The providers for the household are off work? (How financially prepared were we

for this pandemic? If not, will we be ready for the next one? There will be others!)

- Schools and daycare centers close their doors? (Abrianna – *“Mom, I don’t like you being the teacher”* – Kim, *“I don’t like being the teacher!”*)

CONCLUSION:

This if the finest moment of the church! We can’t come to church, so it is time for us to be the church! How can we do that?

- Share this service on your social media platforms...
- Join nightly social media prayer...
- Reach out to those within your circles of influence to see what you can do to help them...
- Share your story of how you came to faith in Christ...

I predict we are going to see the greatest ingathering of new believers in the history of the

church! We can't come to church right now,
why not be the church?

I believe the devil is going to regret having
picked this fight!